

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 42 ft (12.8 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 60–58 MYA
- **HABITAT** Tropical swamps



Aquatic predator

Titanoboa was probably an ambush predator, sneaking up on animals that came near the waterways in which it lurked. Coiling around its victim, *Titanoboa* may have used its strong trunk muscles to grip and slowly suffocate its prey. Numerous, closely packed teeth lined *Titanoboa*'s jaws, possibly indicating that its diet was made up mainly of large, slippery fish.

GIANT BONES



By studying the fossilized vertebrae (backbones) of *Titanoboa*, paleontologists have been able to estimate its enormous size. Measuring about 5 in (12.7 cm) in diameter, each vertebra was so large that it dwarfed the backbones of an adult anaconda (shown in front), the largest snake alive today.

Titanoboa probably shed its skin in one go, like modern snakes.

